

Cloud computing

Around since the 1950s, “the cloud” is a group of specialized computers that provide services through the internet, such as storing files, renting software, and access to hardware.

Cloud storage

Keeping files “in the cloud” helps users to save space on their computers, by storing their files on a cloud provider’s computer and accessing them through a network connection. Cloud storage providers buy massive hard drives, and then sell, or rent, tiny pieces to clients, making it possible for the clients to upgrade and downgrade storage size according to their needs.

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“I don’t need a **hard disk** in my computer if I can get to the **server faster**.”

Steve Jobs (1955–2011),
American co-founder of Apple Inc.

▽ Hybrid cloud storage

In hybrid cloud storage, a copy of each file is stored on the hard drive while a second copy is kept in the cloud. The copies are synchronized and updated frequently.

